turning into national uprising. Several Nepalese Congress leaders had taken shelter in India and King Mahendra believed that these leaders in exile, with the support of the Indian government, were fanning the discontent in Nepal.

The constitution that had come into effect in 1959 was abolished in 1962 and a new constitution was written which returned authority to the throne of Nepal. India had been drawn into the picture when King Mahendra visited eastern Nepal in January 1962 and a cracker was thrown at his Land Rover at Janakpur. Though only two people sustained minor injuries, the Nepalese foreign minister, Tulsi Giri, accused India of political trickery, double standards and subversion on the lines of the US action in Cuba, by permitting Nepalese rebels to use Indian bases to train and organise and conduct hit and run raids in Nepal. The Indian government protested against this 'immoderate statement,' arguing that there was no evidence that Indian territory was being used for hostile actions against Nepal. In February 1962, two violent protests took place inside Nepal which again were laid at India's door. The government of Nepal lodged a protest with the Indian embassy, alleging that the raiders wore uniforms and helmets and belonged to an armed organisation which operated from Indian territory against the government of Nepal. The Indian government responded to the accusation by claiming that several enquiries were conducted but none had shown that the offenders had either entered Nepal from India or later fled to India. Amid the growing animosity between the two neighbours, King Mahendra made a trip to New Delhi on 18 April 1962. An MEA officer, M.J. Desai, noted that during this visit, the king and his officials were in a jittery mood. They wanted the government of India to take all sorts of extra-legal measures against the